

ever, it's a touch costly, since its more compact brother is lighter and smaller. If you're looking for a business solution, you may want to check out the S6410 instead.



Fujitsu S6510

ULTRA COMPACTS True Blue Mobility

Dell XPS M1330

The successor to Dell's ultra compact XPS M1210 gets a slightly larger screen and more horsepower under the bonnet. As with the other Dells, the XPS M1330 is configurable. This one came with a T7500 processor, which while not the latest, is quite fast. Configured with 2 GB of RAM, and a GeForce 8400GS solution, you realise that size doesn't compromise on processing oomph. Then you realise other sub-

BEST BUY
digit
JUNE 2008



Dell XPS M1330

tleties—like the slim white-LED display, the nicely bevelled keypad and the slick working touchpad. While 12.1 inches seemed small for some, 13.3 inches seems like the best possible compromise between size and functionality. In fact, to be honest with the M1330 there's no compromise at all. What you do get is a lot of performance in a form factor that is both great to use, and easy to carry around. With a host of configurable options the M1330 proudly carries the XPS badge to greater heights. HDMI connectivity will be of interest to those looking to connect this to large screen TVs.

It's not niggly-free though. The body panels are of the snap-on variety (which is how Dell offers you colour options). Unfortunately, these snap-ons aren't as firm as you'd like, and you can easily detach one. While not affecting the functions, it's alarming to see the lower bezel of the monitor flap loose with couple of tugs.

At a starting price of Rs 51,000, with the configuration we received priced at around Rs 8,000 more, the XPS M1330 is a true mobile warriors' weapon of choice. You might even buy it as a desktop replacement—it's that good. Although it's larger sibling may have something to say about that.

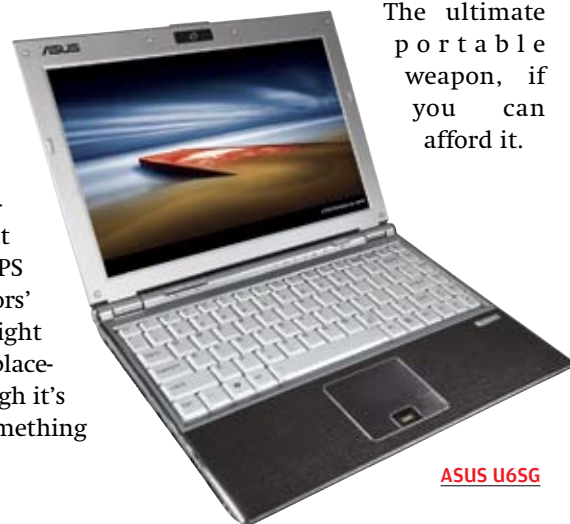
ASUS U6SG

ASUS' answer to the compact offerings around, and all said—a brilliant one. It's got a glossy black lid that resists all but the most determined smudges and the off-white keypad and silver-grey body just exudes class. At 12.1 inches, it's compact enough to lug around just about anywhere. Ergonomics are top class, and the keypad and touchpad alike exude marvellous feedback. The laptop uses an ultra thin white-LED display,

which besides being brilliant and crisp is very slim. This in conjunction with a slim body makes for an unbelievably slim solution. In fact, there was only one solution that was slimmer!

Compact it may be, but this little bruiser has muscle as well. How does a Core 2 Duo T8300 (2.4 GHz) sound? There's 2 GB of memory, and a latest 9 series GPU from NVIDIA (GeForce 9300) with 256 MB of discrete video RAM. Storage is huge too at 250 GB. We'd expect such a configuration from much larger 15.4 inch notebooks, and none of those came with such specifications.

With class-leading ergonomics and design, and such high-end components powering it, we expected the price to be astronomical. At Rs 94,900, the little U6SG is pricey, but it delivers a punch unlike any ultra-compact can, and even leaves many of its larger competitors chewing



ASUS U6SG

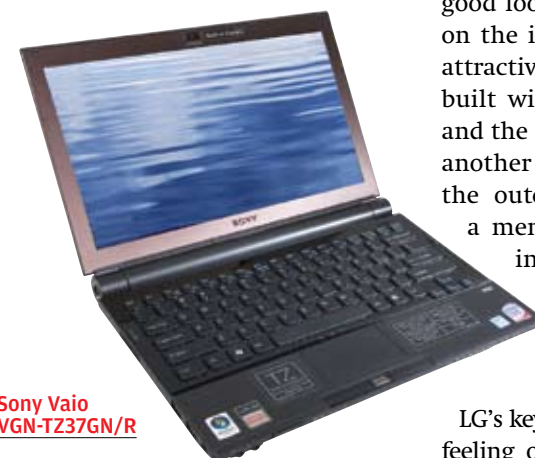
Sony Vaio VGN-TZ37GN/R

The long, confusing name notwithstanding, this notebook struck us as a work of art! It's simply stunning—the kind that only international super-models can aspire to be. The dark copper-red, (coffee coloured if you will), lid, glossy black and charcoal grey body, and the fact that at a mere 11.1 inches of screen size, we've never seen anything lighter, or slimmer for

that matter. Build quality is exemplary, and everything has that distinct upmarket feel, and you're suddenly aware of its pedigree. Like a Ford owner who suddenly beholds a Bentley, we were stunned and spent a lot of time just flocking around it.

Design wise, Sony is flawless here—its lid is barely half a centimetre thick! The display quality doesn't suffer for this—crisp, clear, and with amazing colours. The keys are surprisingly well spaced out, and amazingly usable for its tiny size, and the configuration is punchy (don't expect discrete graphics though). A biometrics device for recognising your fingerprints hasn't been left out, and with 2 GB of RAM this little feline can bare rather large claws.

At Rs 1,14,900, the Vaio VGN-TZ37GN/R isn't for everybody. But it wasn't meant to be. Like the Rolex's and Rolls Royce's of our era, it was meant to be pursued by only those who can appreciate its pedigree.



Sony Vaio VGN-TZ37GN/R

HCL Z29 C2D

This is HCL's compact offering, and while it doesn't even claim to be in the same league as the ones before it, the Z29 C2D is a Core 2 Duo T5550 (1.83 GHz) based 12.1 notebook. We couldn't figure out why HCL added the diamond cut patterns on the lid—this brings back unpleasant memories of Nokia's Prism.

This notebook is well built, and except for its lid, which seems flimsy and doesn't tilt back, we couldn't find much to complain about. Oh!—Wait a minute, there was the issue with the



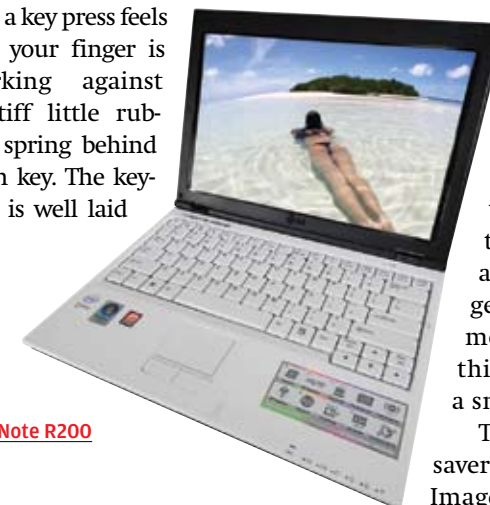
HCL Z29 C2D

keypad where the 'function' key is placed to the extreme left where the [Ctrl] key should be. This causes a lot of inconvenience when using the [Ctrl] key for any purpose, especially shortcuts. And did we mention that it's a little too thick for a 12.1 inch. In fact, any thicker and we wouldn't have put it into this category.

LG XNote R200

The XNote 200 is a compact laptop with a 12.1 inch screen and is a good looker. The matte white finish on the inside is eye catching if not attractive. The R200 feels very well built with excellent fit and finish, and the slightly thicker screen holds another small LCD display built into the outer lid. This little LCD has a menu of its own, and you are informed of new mails, and get important updates on it without even opening the lid.

We really like the feel of LG's keyboard; the keys exude a solid feeling of feedback, and a key press feels like your finger is working against a stiff little rubber spring behind each key. The keypad is well laid



LG XNote R200

out too. LG drops in a surprisingly good configuration—a Core 2 Duo T7300 (2.0 GHz), 2 GB of RAM and a Radeon HD2400 graphics solution with 128 MB of dedicated video memory. The R200 should be good as a desktop replacement except that it's got a small screen and will serve portability nuts well.

At Rs 62,000 the XNote R200 is a well-priced notebook for its configuration and compact size. It's not as compact as the slimmer Dell XPS M1330, which also manages a better configuration. The M1330 also kills it in the pricing department. If you don't mind the stubby profile, and like the extra screen as much as to shell out Rs 10,000 more for it, then buy this by all means.

Sahara ImageBook 8WS

Sahara's ImageBook is a really compact notebook with a huge monitor bezel for some inexplicable reason, making it bulky for just an eight inch screen. The first issue is with the build quality which isn't very appealing, neither is the finish, a plain steel grey. The second major issue was with the battery retention which leaves some room for play, so your battery will move around slightly. While battery contact isn't affected, it isn't comforting to have a loose battery.

The screen is not very clear and accounting for the lack of display size this is a double whammy. Sahara could easily have provided an 11-inch screen with such a body size. This was the only notebook to feature an AMD processor, the new power-saving Geode LX clocked at 800 MHz. What we also couldn't figure out was the lack of memory—the ImageBook comes with a paltry 256 MB. You can forget about running anything more than Windows XP on this notebook—and that too at a snail's pace.

The price is a bit of a life saver though—at Rs 14,999 the ImageBook 8WS is very, very